



THE ANVIL



MACG

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Free

PINE GAP IS A US WAR BASE



Pine Gap

Source: Department of Defence

The so-called “joint defence facility” at Pine Gap, near Alice Springs, is a US war base. It is an essential part of the US global war machine and has played a crucial part in numerous US wars. It is currently playing an important part in Israel’s genocide in Gaza.

The Base

An agreement to establish a US military base at Pine Gap was made in 1966 and

operations began in 1970. Headed by a CIA officer, with staff from that agency, the National Security Agency and the National Reconnaissance Office, it has over 800 staff. It controls spy satellites as they pass over one third of the world, including China, Korea, Eastern Russia, and West Asia. Central Australia was chosen because it was too remote for spy ships to intercept its signals from international waters.



What is Anarchism?

Anarchism is a social philosophy based upon the principles of liberty, equality and solidarity. It is the political dimension of a free society.

What is Communism?

Communism is the principle of “from each according to their ability, to each according to their need”. It is the economic dimension of a free society.

What is the Melbourne Anarchist Communist Group?

The MACG is an organisation of class struggle revolutionary anarchists who share political positions, articulated in theory, strategy and tactics.

We aim to encourage struggle by the working class for its own interests and, within that struggle, we aim to advance Anarchist ideas as its necessary philosophical basis.

Pine Gap has a number of roles. They include monitoring other countries' nuclear weapons activities, selecting targets for US nuclear weapons, selecting targets for other US weapons wherever they choose to strike, relaying warnings of enemy missiles, geolocating electronic signals from devices like mobile phones and last, but not least, hoovering up vast quantities of phone and Internet data on the off chance it might be useful to Uncle Sam in some way.

Dirty Deeds Done Dirt Cheap

Most of what has been done at Pine Gap is secret and likely won't be known until the revolution, but some selected highlights have become public. During the Vietnam War, Pine Gap was used for pinpointing targets for the US bombing of Cambodia. When Iraq launched Scud missiles at Israel during the Gulf War in 1991, Pine Gap relayed information to the IDF. It has located targets for the criminal US drone wars in Pakistan, Afghanistan, Yemen & elsewhere. Currently, it is providing communications and electronic intelligence to the IDF for use in Gaza.

While officially Pine Gap is a “joint facility”, it's really US run from top to bottom and Australian participation is just for show.

This isn't because Australia is some oppressed country under the heel of the US – like maybe half the world is – but because the Australian ruling class has no problems with the US making all the big calls at Pine Gap. It's a US-dominated world order, but that suits Australian imperialism just fine. Australia gets its own sphere of interest in the South Pacific and Timor Leste, while the US erects a big “Keep Out” sign to exclude Australia's rivals.

Continued ...

Gaza

Australia is assisting Israel's Gaza genocide as part of its commitment to the US-dominated world order.

By geolocating mobile phone signals, Pine Gap is providing real-time intelligence to the IDF, which is used to assassinate presumed Hamas members, or other targets, when they are at home with their families.

When the media announce the death of a journalist, doctor or alleged Hamas member who died with their family when their home was bombed in the middle of the night, the probability is that Pine Gap played a role in the attack. It should be noted that it's not uncommon for the ostensible target to have left the building by the time the bombers arrive – but the family members die anyway.

As the MACG has previously argued, the unions in Australia should black ban the export of war materiel, automobiles and oil and petroleum products to Israel. These bans would hit the Israeli war machine hard, especially given the essential role played by Australian companies in manufacturing parts for the F35 fighter-bombers. Just as important though, is stopping the contribution of Pine Gap to the genocide in Gaza. For this, unions would need to black ban the supply of electricity, water and communications services to the base. Depending on the circumstances,

deliveries of goods might also need to be banned.

The Political Struggle

When we advocate these measures, the MACG is not assuming that the union officials will take them up enthusiastically. On the contrary, the officials, whose loyalty is in most cases to the ALP rather than to their members, will at best be lukewarm towards action on the job to stop the Israeli war machine. Typically, they will be intensely hostile to black bans.

To act effectively to stop the genocide, workers need to be organised on the job and build a rank-and-file movement to impose their will on the union officials. In the course of this process, the ALP's stranglehold within our unions will need to be defeated. This will enable Australian assistance to the Israeli war machine to be stopped, but it would also be a major blow to US imperialism worldwide. The defeat of the ALP in the unions would also enable the revival of militant unions to truly fight for the interests of the working class across the board. The rank-and-file movement could fight for wages and conditions, to defend health and safety, to protect the environment and to stop racism, sexism, homophobia and all other forms of oppression. No social problem can be solved without working class action and all social problems can be solved with it.

**END ANZUS
STOP AUKUS
CLOSE PINE GAP**

Our schools are in crisis



NSW public school teachers during a strike in December, 2021, over staff shortages and salaries
Source: AAP / Mick Tsikas

School working conditions are students' learning conditions. Educators – both teachers and education support staff – are at a breaking point. The system is hurtling towards leaving a generation of working class children in a significantly worse position than their parents. Educators must take control of fixing this problem from the bottom up.

Putting aside the grotesque industry of private education, even our public education system reflects the worst aspects of class society. Wealthy, inner-city schools have the resources, facilities, and professional support to attract and maintain experienced education staff. At the same time, working class suburbs are left underfunded, under-supported and are forced to spend more of their meagre budget

trying to incentivise teachers to take ever-increasingly demanding roles.

The last state-wide agreement prioritised 'workload' reductions over pay. However, the Government failed to hire the necessary staff – leaving hard-to-staff schools operating with a staff capacity as low as 60% in some cases. The perverse outcome of prioritising workload reductions over pay has resulted in fully staffed (because traditionally easier-to-staff) government schools being able to implement a key improvement in conditions with relative ease. However, this has come at the expense of hard-to-staff schools and their educators, who have been left drowning in excessive and unsafe workloads.



The path forward is clear. A radical change to education working conditions is required. This cannot be achieved by another government inquiry – it must come from those of us at the coal face. Educators are experienced professionals. We know how to educate the next generation but we need additional support and a major reduction in unnecessary meetings and Department driven paper-pushing activities.

To achieve the power required to truly transform our working conditions and thus the learning conditions of students at our schools, we need a strong union.

While the Australian Education Union (AEU) Victoria Branch has been bleeding members, the foundations of a

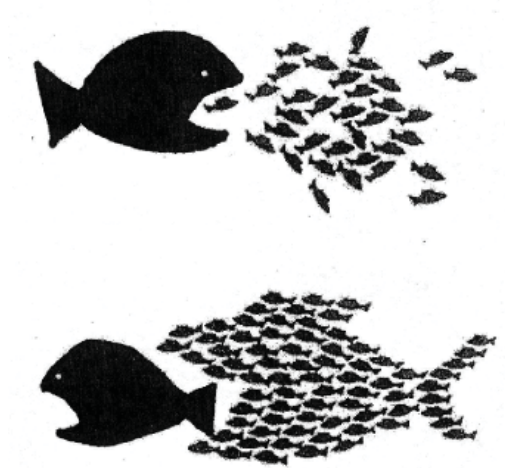
fighting union with 40,000+ members is still there. We must rebuild rank-and-file militancy within the AEU. This must be driven from below – starting at the sub-branches at each-and-every school. Increased density, increased militancy, and increased organisation will form the basis of a fighting working class movement of educations.

For a revolutionary working class movement to succeed we need a broad base of the working class engaged in their unions. If you're an educator and want to build a fighting union contact us.

**DARE TO STRUGGLE
DARE TO WIN**



ANARCHISM 101: Organisation



Anarchist? Organisation? Surely that's a contradiction in terms!

This is still one of the most common 'mainstream' objections that anarchists encounter. The Italian anarchist Errico Malatesta responded to this topic at length.

Malatesta argued that human society is synonymous with organisation. Everything we require to live, from food to housing to education, is the product of cooperation and interaction with multitudes of other human beings. In order to live, humans have to associate for various purposes, and adopt the forms and means required to achieve those purposes. Which is to say, in order to live, humans build organisation.

The ruling class tells us that organisation cannot exist without 'authority', the idea that some are in command, and others must obey. To maintain this authority, all manner of violent coercion is required. The notion that there is no organisation without authority is a self-serving lie concocted by rulers of all kinds trying to

defend their parasitic existence.

At the heart of anarchism is the idea that humans can organise and live and produce everything we need without masters, without a ruling class, and without any special group in command that everyone else must obey. Authority is not a prerequisite to social organisation, but a hindrance upon it. The ruling class gives us wars, poverty and environmental destruction, whilst syphoning off the wealth produced by the working class.

Political Organisation and Class Organisation

To us it only makes sense that we should unite with others who share our politics, reach agreement on strategy, share resources, and cooperate to advance our politics. Comrades who refuse to organise squander their time and energy on ineffective and isolated action, before falling into inactivity, and leaving the next generation of anarchists the task of once again rebuilding our politics.

We seek to build an organisation that unites committed revolutionary anarchists from across the working class, in order to advance our politics and strategy. This organisation cannot be separate from the working class. Anarchist ideas are a historical development of the experiences of workers, who as an exploited class seek to create a new world free of tyranny and exploitation in any form. The challenge before us is to make these ideas the leading ideas of struggle within the working class.

But it is not enough to only build anarchist organisation. The minority of workers who are convinced of anarchism are not enough to make a revolution. We should not make convincing everyone of every aspect of our ideas a prerequisite for revolutionary struggle. To convince people of our ideas, we need to struggle alongside them. This means that beyond the political organisation, anarchists must enter and build wider organisations of class struggle.

We call the wider organisations of class struggle *mass organisations*. Within the mass organisations we argue for anarchist principles and methods of struggle. We argue for ever greater and wider solidarity between struggles. We show that our own struggles and other struggles are linked, that we face common enemies, and that the issues we face have systematic causes rooted in capitalism.

We want to make anarchism the leading idea in struggle, but we never want to make the mass organisations officially “anarchist”. To be effective, mass

organisations of class struggle must draw in all workers prepared to struggle, and not just those we can convince of anarchism.

Within organisations of class struggle we argue for direct action, and we fight against hierarchical control and for movement democracy. We argue for these principles and methods both because we believe these are the best methods for winning the immediate demands of movements today, and because we believe these methods and principles equip movements to fight and defeat greater enemies tomorrow.

By participating and fighting for our ideas within the organisations of struggle that exist and emerge today, we hope to support the development of the mass organisation of the working class that can make and win the social revolution against capitalism tomorrow.



New Caledonia “riots”



A Kanak solidarity rally in France
Source: Union Communiste Libertaire

“Anything that happens in New Caledonia is of interest to the nickel industry”, the Financial Review reports. The French government is pouring soldiers and police into Kanaky (New Caledonia). Kanaky possesses an estimated 25% of the world’s known nickel reserves and accounts for approximately 6% of global nickel production.

The French state maintains the fiction that “New Caledonia” is part of France, in truth it is a colony. France seized Kanaky in 1853, drove Indigenous Kanak people from their land, introduced diseases, perpetrated massacres, confined Kanak people to “reservations”, and sought to replace the Kanak population with European migrants. Today, three major companies exploit Kanaky for its nickel reserves. All three are ultimately owned by multinationals with their roots in France.

Nickel is a key component of the lithium-ion batteries used in electric vehicles, and the electric vehicle industry is expanding rapidly. China is rapidly becoming a centre of electric vehicle manufacture and threatens to outcompete European car manufacturers. French capitalists fear that an independent Kanaky could decide to sell the rights to its nickel mines to Chinese capitalists rather than French ones.

This is why the French state is trying to undo its past promises to ‘New Caledonia’. In 1998 France signed the Nouméa Accord, which promised greater Kanak political power and the possibility of Independence. Under the terms of the Nouméa Accord, voting in provincial elections was restricted to people who had resided in New Caledonia prior to 1998, and their children. France is now seeking to undo this process. A recent constitutional amendment would expand the franchise to recent French settlers, further marginalising Kanak people, and heading off the prospect of a successful independence referendum.

The French state is intent on maintaining control over its last Pacific colony, and Australia implicitly supports France in this aim. As anarchists the path is clear, we must support the struggle against colonial rule.

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